

Smoke Testing

A short set of critical checks used to decide whether a build is stable enough for further testing.

Purpose

Quickly detect blocking failures in essential functions before investing in broader execution.

Scope

Use a few high-value scenarios: access, core navigation, authentication, critical transaction and essential integrations.

When

After deployment, a new build, environment change or before regression/UAT.

Outcome

A critical-flow failure may justify blocking subsequent execution until the risk is understood.

When to use it

Use this knowledge when product risk, architecture or the delivery stage requires this type of validation. Confirm the goal, environment, required data and expected evidence before starting.

How QA applies it

Start from the behavior or risk to validate, prepare data and environment, execute the technique or tool reproducibly and capture evidence that helps the team understand the result.

QA tip

Smoke should be fast, deterministic and focused on what could block further validation.